

SNAPSHOTS 2018

Accidents in India

	2017	2018
Accidental Deaths	3,96,584	4,11,824
Rate of Accidental Deaths	30.3	31.1

- ❖ Maximum casualties were reported in age group 30 years & above – below 45 years (1,27,199 deaths, 30.9%) followed by 18 years – below 30 years (1,11,198 deaths, 27.0%) during 2018.

Accidents due to Forces of Nature

- ❖ A total of 6,891 deaths in the country due to causes attributable to forces of nature were reported during the year 2018.
- ❖ Out of 6,891 accidental deaths attributable to forces of nature, 34.2% deaths due to 'Lightning', 12.9% deaths due to 'Heat/Sun Stroke' and 11.0% deaths due to 'Exposure to Cold' were reported during the year 2018.
- ❖ Majority of the victims who died due to accidents caused by forces of nature were reported to be belonging to the age-group of 30-60 years. They accounted for 50.0% of all persons died in accidents attributable to forces of nature during the year 2018.
- ❖ Out of total accidental deaths due to forces of nature, 'Lightning' was the major cause of deaths in Chhattisgarh (89.5%), Madhya Pradesh (80.7%), Karnataka (76.8%) and West Bengal (65.1%) during the year 2018.
- ❖ A total of 448 deaths due to causes attributable to forces of nature were reported in 53 mega cities.

Accidents due to Other Causes

- ❖ Under this head are the causes other than Forces of Nature which result in accidents/deaths. They include deliberate or negligent conduct on the part of human beings.
- ❖ A total of 7,02,094 cases were reported during 2018 in which 4,04,933 persons died and 4,54,244 persons injured.
- ❖ Male-Female ratio in fatality during 2018 was –80.4:19.6.
- ❖ Majority of the deaths were in the age group of 18 to 45 years. This group of people has accounted for more than half (58.1%) of all persons killed in 'accidents due to other causes' in the country during the year 2018.

- ❖ The major causes of accidental deaths were (i) 'Traffic Accidents' (44.2%), (ii) 'Sudden Deaths' (11.4%), (iii) 'Drowning' (7.5%), (iv) 'Poisoning' (5.3%), (v) 'Falls (5.0%) and (vi) 'Accidental Fire' (3.1%).
- ❖ A total of 13,099 cases of fire accidents were reported in the country during 2018 which rendered 12,748 deaths and injuries to 777 persons.
- ❖ Electrocution and snake bite caused 12,154 (3.0%) and 8,962 (2.2%) deaths respectively during 2018.

Traffic Accidents

- ❖ A total of 4,74,638 'Traffic Accidents' were reported during the year comprising 4,45,514 'Road Accidents', 1,481 'Railway Crossing Accidents' and 27,643 'Railway Accidents'. The traffic accidents caused injuries to 4,49,981 persons and 1,78,832 deaths during 2018.
- ❖ The percentage share of deaths in traffic accidents due to 'Road Accidents', 'Railway Accidents' and 'Railway Crossing Accidents' was reported as 85.4% (1,52,780 deaths), 13.7% (24,545 deaths) and 0.8% (1,507 deaths) respectively during 2018.
- ❖ It is worth noting that January (42,949) and May (42,825) accounted for maximum number of traffic accidents in the country. As per time period wise analysis, maximum number of traffic accidents (88,792) were reported during 18:00 hrs to 21:00 hrs.

Road Accidents

- ❖ During 2018, a total of 4,45,514 cases of 'Road Accidents' were reported which rendered 4,46,518 persons injured and 1,52,780 deaths.
- ❖ It is observed that the rate of deaths under Road Accidents per thousand vehicles is 0.6 in 2018.
- ❖ 35.7% victims of road accidents were riders of 'two wheelers'. Trucks / lorries, cars and buses have accounted for 15.9%, 13.9% and 6.9% respectively of road accidental deaths.
- ❖ Majority of road accidents were due to over speeding accounting for 59.3% of total accidents which caused 84,346 deaths and 2,74,997 persons injured. Dangerous/careless driving or overtaking caused 1,09,695 (24.6%) road accidents which rendered 41,653 deaths and 1,00,458 persons injured during 2018. Besides, only 2.5% of road accidents were due to poor weather conditions.
- ❖ A total of 40 accidental deaths were reported at un-manned railway crossing during 2018.
- ❖ 58.2% and 41.8% of road accidents were reported in rural areas (2,59,161 cases) and urban areas (1,86,353 cases) respectively during 2018.
- ❖ 30.6% (1,36,486 cases out of 4,45,514 cases) of total road accidents were reported near residential areas during 2018.

Railway Accidents

- ❖ A total of 27,643 cases of railway accidents were reported during the year 2018. 27,643 railways accidents rendered 3,431 persons injured and 24,545 deaths during 2018.
- ❖ Majority of railways accidents cases were reported under 'Fall from trains / collision with people on track' (18,894 out of 27,643), accounting for 68.4% of railway accidents during 2018.

Railway Crossing Accidents

- ❖ A total of 1,481 cases of railway crossing accidents were reported which caused 1,507 deaths and 32 persons were injured during 2018.
- ❖ Uttar Pradesh (656 out of 1,481 cases) has reported the maximum cases of railway crossing accidents, accounted for 44.3% of total such accidents.

Suicides in India

	2017	2018
Suicides	1,29,887	1,34,516
Rate of Suicides	9.9	10.2

- ❖ An increase was observed in suicides during 2018 (1,34,516 suicides) as compared to 2017 (1,29,887 suicides).
- ❖ The suicide rate in cities (13.3) was higher as compared to all-India suicide rate (10.2).
- ❖ 'Family Problems (other than marriage related problems)' (30.4%) and 'Illness' (17.7%) have together accounted for 48.1% of total suicides in the country during the year 2018.
- ❖ The overall male: female ratio of suicide victims for the year 2018 was 68.5:31.5.
- ❖ Nearly 70.3% of the male victims were married while 65.4% of female victims were married.
- ❖ 12.7% victims of suicide were illiterate, 17.1% victims of suicide were educated upto primary level, 19.5% of the suicide victims were educated up to middle level and 23.6% of the suicide victims were educated up to matric level.
- ❖ Suicide by 'Hanging' (51.5%), Consuming 'Poison' (26.7%), 'Drowning' (4.9%) and 'Self-Immolation' (4.4%) were the prominent means of committing suicides during 2018.
- ❖ Maximum cases of mass/family suicide were reported from Tamil Nadu (15) followed by Andhra Pradesh (11), Madhya Pradesh (9) and Punjab & Rajasthan (6 each), during the year 2018.

Accidents and Suicides in Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF)

- ❖ A total of 104 CAPF personnel lost their lives in various accidents during 2018.
- ❖ 31.7% and 21.2% casualties in CAPFs were due to 'Killed in Action/Operation/Encounters etc.' and 'Deaths due to Other Causes (Except Road/Railway Accidents)' respectively.
- ❖ A total of 28 CAPF personnel committed suicide during 2018.
- ❖ 35.7% and 17.9% of total victims in CAPFs have committed suicides due to 'Family Problems' and 'Marriage Related Issues' respectively.
- ❖ 5 suicides were reported in Haryana, followed by Arunachal Pradesh & Assam (3 suicides each) and Chhattisgarh, Jammu & Kashmir, Meghalaya, Tamil Nadu & West Bengal (2 suicides each) during 2018. These 8 States/UTs together accounted for 75.0% (21 out of 28) of total suicides in CAPFs in the country.